



▲ **Gandhi saw railway stations** as the perfect platform to address the thousands of followers that came to get a glimpse of their leader. This November 1946 photograph shows Gandhi speaking to a large crowd at a railway station in modern-day Bangladesh.

On a cold night in 1893, as young Gandhi walked to the waiting room of the Pietermaritzburg station in South Africa, he felt the weight of disempowerment looming large around him. He, a Britain-trained barrister, had just suffered the indignity of being forcibly thrown out of his first-class carriage because his fellow traveller – a Caucasian – refused to share the space with a coloured man. Gandhi would later recognize this incident as a pivotal one. The racial prejudice he faced that night not only informed his activism in South Africa, but set into motion the making of the man who would become the “Father of the Nation”.